

10 WEEKS

Though not obvious to others, you may start to notice that your body is beginning to look pregnant.



Baby watch

📏 1½ in (4.1 cm) ⚖️ ¼ oz (7 g)

Your baby is now classified as a fetus. The limbs are growing and the neck has lengthened, enabling your baby to make kicking and squirming movements, though it will be a few weeks before you feel them. The heart now has a basic structure, with four chambers, and it beats rapidly, up to 160 beats a minute, as it circulates blood around the body.

Mom matters

Your uterus starts to move up and out of the pelvis as it grows. This shift in its position means less pressure on your bladder. Your breasts continue to grow, and you may go up two or three bra sizes by the end of this trimester. It is normal to feel increasingly breathless—your body needs to take in more air, which is directed toward the baby, uterus, and placenta—but mention it to your doctor if you are alarmed.



This week...

- » Look at your employee handbook to see whether you'll be offered maternity leave.
- » If your breasts are tender, wear a softer bra at night.
- » Start looking into childbirth classes to sign up for.

11 WEEKS

You may see your baby for the first time on your first ultrasound. It's the start of your love affair!



Baby watch

📏 2½ in (5.4 cm) ⚖️ ½ oz (14 g)

Your baby is roughly the size of a lime. The brain is forming left and right hemispheres and at the same time, primitive reflexes are developing. Your baby may move in response to pressure on the abdomen. Facial features are developing. The eyelids are fused together and will remain tightly shut until about 26 weeks, but the eyes and ears are not quite in their final position.

Mom matters

You may need to adjust your waistband or opt for looser-fitting garments. Pregnancy hormones can mean your nipples and areolae darken and become bigger. By now, up to a quarter of the blood pumped around your body is being sent to the uterus to support the rapid growth of your baby and the placenta.

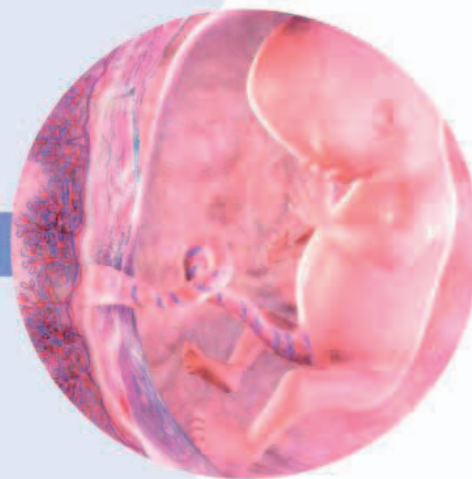


This week...

- » A first ultrasound is done between 8 and 14 weeks. Various measurements are taken and you are given an estimated delivery date (EDD). The ultrasound also checks whether you are having one baby or more.
- » You may have first screening tests to assess your baby's risk of chromosomal and genetic conditions. Your doctor will talk to you about what is available.

12 WEEKS

With nausea and fatigue fading away, you are likely to feel more invigorated.



Baby watch

📏 2½ in (7.4 cm) ⚖️ ¾ oz (23 g)

By the end of this first trimester, the head is still large in proportion to the body, taking up about half the crown-rump length. The heart is fully functional, but the heart rate slows down. As the chest wall forms, your baby starts to practice breathing movements, and may also hiccup and swallow. The mouth, stomach, and intestines are now linked. The placenta is ready to take over the job of nourishing your baby.

Mom matters

Some of the more unpleasant symptoms of early pregnancy may start to recede, and you may feel great relief as your appetite returns, and your energy levels increase. The hormone hCG falls significantly now, which may be behind the nausea subsiding. For some women, nausea can continue to around week 20. If this is the case, rest assured that your baby will still be getting all the nutrients she needs, even if you are suffering!



This week...

- » If you've been waiting until your first ultrasound to tell family and friends, have fun breaking the good news.
- » You may be offered the nuchal translucency test around now (often at the same time as your first ultrasound). This is used to help assess your baby's risk of Down syndrome.